How I'd Make My First Million With AI

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 21, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UraCP4mm2oc Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter (earned first million at 32, coached 15,000+ online fitness entrepreneurs) lays out a step-by-step AI-powered blueprint: pick a high-ticket service niche, hack viral content, and convert viewers into clients through an automated secret sales funnel.

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🏪 Step 1: Choose a Service-Based Business 1:13

- Start with a **service business**, not a product business
  - No product development, no inventory, no shipping, no storage
  - Run entirely from a laptop, from anywhere in the world → maximum freedom
  - Lower overhead = lower risk of running out of money
    - 80% of businesses fail; reducing cash burn is the single biggest survival lever
- Examples of viable remote services:
  - AI automation setup for businesses
  - Ad management (Facebook/Instagram)
  - Video editing
  - Bookkeeping

    - Coaching (fitness, business, any skill-based domain)
- Brandon's recommended starting point: **coaching**, because it has near-zero marginal cost and scales well
    - Real example: a student paid Brandon to coach him on teaching people to flip/refurbish phones on eBay — eventually made $1M/year from it
    - You don't need formal credentials; if you've achieved a result yourself or helped others, you're qualified

🎯 Step 2: Niche Down Ruthlessly 1:57

- The single biggest beginner mistake: choosing a market instead of a niche
    - "I help people get fit with diet and exercise" → competing with every fitness influencer on earth
    - "I help businesses make money with Facebook ads" → competing with every media buyer on earth
- The niche formula has three components:
    - **Who** (specific target audience)
    - **What** (exact problem you solve, in their language)
    - **How** (your unique mechanism / method)
- Brandon's personal example when he started online fitness:
    - Who: men aged 25–35 only
    - What: get jacked / become muscular (NOT "reduce body fat via caloric deficit" — use their words)
    - How: intermittent fasting + high-intensity interval training + cardio
    - Result: when that exact person found him, there was zero price comparison — he stood out completely
- Jen Caesar case study (community member, full-time nurse, 40+ hrs/week, two young kids):
    - Who: busy working moms (not all women, not stay-at-home moms — specifically *working* moms)
    - What: lose fat and tone up (trainers hate the word "tone" — ignore them; it's what clients say)
    - How: at home
    - Content showed her cooking, working out with kids present, doing "mom things" → spoke directly to that audience
    - **Earned $39,500 in January of her first full year, $49,927 in April; still growing**
- Corey Armstrong case study:
    - One-sentence offer: "I help men over 30 get jacked and optimize their hormones naturally."
    - Grew from 2,000 followers and zero online coaching experience to **$400,000–$470,000/year**, moved from inner-city Detroit to Miami, bought his mother a car
- The specialist analogy: LASIK surgeon who only does eyes with thousands of reviews vs. general practitioner who also does eye surgery — you always pick the specialist, who also charges more
- Niche psychology — know your audience's *real* motivation:
    - Men 25–35 → primarily motivated by attracting women → Brandon's old marketing featured women in sports bras (not to attract women, to attract the young men)

    - Shift audience to men 35–45 → motivation shifts to family, energy for kids, longevity → completely different content style required
- Can you be *too* niche? Rarely, but yes — example given: "one-armed dwarves learning basketball with trampoline training" — total addressable market too small
- Your one-sentence offer test: anyone who hears it should instantly know *who* you help, *what* you help them achieve, and *how*
    - Brandon: "I help trainers grow their online fitness businesses with AI."
    - Jen: "I help busy working moms lose fat and tone up at home."
    - Corey: "I help men over 30 get jacked and optimize their hormones naturally."

💰 Step 3: Price High from Day One 4:10

- Common beginner instinct: sell something cheap ($50 program, $50–$100/month community)
    - Problem: need **200 paying members** at $50/month just to hit $10,000/month
    - Most beginners have never sold 200 of anything and lack the reputation to justify it
    - Comparison: many adults won't pay $20/month for ChatGPT — why would they pay an unknown?
- High-ticket path to $10,000/month:
    - Price point ~$997
    - Need only **~10 clients** instead of 200
    - Much easier to close 10 people than 200
- $10,000/month = $120,000/year — roughly 2× the average American income; enough to quit a full-time job and reinvest time to scale to $20K, $30K, $50K+
- Caveat: you must be able to *deliver* a $1,000 result — the offer has to genuinely solve a significant problem

🤖 Step 4: Use AI to Validate & Understand Your Niche 13:23

- Use any top AI model; Brandon uses Gemini (fast) but all work
    - Gemini: use Argon tier
    - ChatGPT: use Astra (or Soul for budget); max plan ~$500/month
    - Claude: use Opus 5.5 (currently better than Fable) — always set to Ultra/max
- **Prompt to find your niche:**
    - "I'm starting an online [type] business, but I need to nail my niche. I need to figure out exactly who my target audience is, what problem I'm going to focus on, and what my specialization is to help them with that. I want you to interview me and ask me questions until you have enough information to come up with five different niches for me."
    - AI will ask questions one by one → answer them → receive five niche suggestions
    - Pro tip: if the AI dumps all questions at once, say "ask me one question at a time" — later questions will build on earlier answers, making them sharper
- **Prompt to understand your audience's psychology:**

- "I need to know everything about this target audience I've chosen. What motivates them? What is their primary goal in life? Why exactly do they want to achieve these goals? Because I need to make sure my marketing speaks to that."
- Ensures your content actually *resonates* with the audience, not just names them in a bio

📣 Step 5: Generate Leads with Organic Content (Niche Hacking) 21:04

- Once niche is set, create content that helps your audience reach their goal via your method
- Strategy: **Niche Hacking** — find content that already works in your niche and create your own version
- Look for **10x Outliers**: videos/reels that have 10× more views than the creator's follower count
  - Why this matters: the algorithm changed — follower count no longer guarantees views
  - How the algorithm works now:
    - New content is shown to a small test group (mix of followers and non-followers)
    - If engagement is good → shown to a larger group (Test 2)
    - If Test 2 passes → shown to an even larger group, mostly non-followers
    - If it keeps passing → goes viral, reaching people who've never heard of you
    - This means a creator with 2,000 followers can get 2.2M views (real example: Rossfit)
  - A video with 1M views from an account with 1.4M followers is NOT a 10x outlier — skip it
  - A video with 5.5M views from an account with 125,000 followers IS a 10x outlier — study it
- Language rule: **never use jargon or technical terms** — speak the way your audience speaks
  - Bad: "create a caloric deficit to increase lipolyse and oxidation"
  - Good: "just eat healthier and diet"
  - Jargon attracts other professionals who won't buy; plain language attracts actual clients
- Content must *look and feel* like your audience's world — not just mention them in a bio

🔎 Step 6: Find 10x Outlier Videos with AI Tools 21:50

- **Tool 1 — Sorter (Chrome extension for TikTok & Instagram)**
  - Free Chrome extension (Chrome only)
  - Adds extra engagement data to Instagram/TikTok search results
  - Search your niche keyword, then scan for posts where views >> follower count
- **Tool 2 — VidIQ**
  - Primarily for YouTube but works across social platforms
  - Relatively cheap; plug it into ChatGPT as an integration
  - Prompt: "Use VidIQ to find outlier reels in the [your] niche" → returns ranked results
  - Real example: found community member American Stallion (Steven) via VidIQ search; DMed him; he confirmed earning $80–90K/month organic revenue
- **Tool 3 — Scrape Creators (MCP tool)**

    - Paid tool but comes with 100 free credits
    - Add as an MCP to any LLM (Claude, ChatGPT/Codex, Grokbot, etc.)
    - Can scrape and transcribe any public reel/video
    - Can also *find* outliers automatically — Brandon set up Grokbot to scan every morning and add new outliers to a Notion database automatically
- **Tool 4 — Viral Content Vault** (fitness niche only)
    - Brandon's free tool: a constantly updated database of hundreds of fitness outliers
    - Link in video description
- Grokbot setup example:
    - Prompt: "Use Scrape Creators to find outlier reels about editing video with Claude. Add them to this Notion database. Do this every morning automatically."
    - Result: database populates daily with zero manual effort
    - Caveat: Grokbot (Grok) is expensive; Brandon notes he had to "set aside his feelings about Elon Musk" but concedes it's a genuinely good product

🔁 Step 7: Recreate Outliers Without Copying 25:12

- **Never copy word-for-word** — risks DMCA, destroys credibility before you've started
- Music analogy: there are only 12 keys; many songs share the same chord progression (skeleton), yet they're distinct because they have different lyrics, melodies, rhythms, and tempos
    - Take the structure (key + chord progression) but write your own lyrics
- AI workflow to recreate an outlier:
    - Copy the outlier video's URL
    - Open Claude (or ChatGPT/Gemini)
    - Prompt: "Use Scrape Creators to transcribe this video and tell me why you think it went viral. Then interview me and ask me questions so I can write my own version of this video in my own style without plagiarizing or copying this creator."
    - Claude will: transcribe → analyze virality → ask you questions one by one → generate your custom script
    - The resulting script uses the same *structure* as the viral video but your words, voice, and expertise
- Only recreate content you can authentically deliver:
    - If the outlier went viral because the creator has an exceptional physique (like "Ben" with 2.8M views / 340K likes who "looks like a baby Thanos"), that only works if you look the part
    - If the outlier is a dramatic body transformation (Rossfit lost 19 kg, got 2.2M views with 15K followers), don't try to copy it if you've never been overweight
    - Choose outliers where your personal story and appearance fit

🕵️ Step 8: The Secret Sales Funnel 31:39

- Goal: convert content viewers into sales calls without ever appearing salesy
- How it works (step by step):
  - **Post content** (your 10x outlier-style reels)
  - **Include a CTA** in the content: "Comment the word [X] and I'll send you my free [guide/tool/PDF]"
  - **Automated DM** goes out with a link to the free resource
  - **Conversation opens** in DM — follow a qualification script:
    - "Hey, I see you downloaded the free guide. What are your current goals?"
    - "How long have you been working on this?"
    - "What's the main thing stopping you from reaching your goals?"
    - "I've helped a few clients with that exact problem — here are some examples. Want to hop on a call so I can show you how I can help?"
  - **Sales call booked** → close the deal
- Why it's "secret": you're publicly giving away free value; the actual selling happens privately in DMs — you never look like a salesperson
- Corey Armstrong's results with this method:
  - One reel on blood sugar → 38,000 comments with the keyword "A1C" for his free Diabetes Destroyer course
  - At just 1% conversion to a sales call and close → **380 sales from one reel**
  - Other reels: 5,400 comments, 3,000 comments, 2,000 comments — all driving DM conversations
  - Products used as comment triggers: "Win PDFs" (free mini-courses on specific topics like testosterone, blood sugar)

> The secret sales funnel works because you're selling in private while giving away in public — you never come across as pushy, yet every piece of content generates pipeline.

🛠️ Step 9: Build Interactive Lead Magnets with GoHighLevel 35:29

- Don't just give away a static PDF — build **interactive lead magnets** for higher perceived value
- Brandon's example: the "Ripped Road Map" quiz (built in GoHighLevel)
  - User fills in: gender, age, height, weight, goal, uploads a photo
  - AI estimates body fat percentage from photo
  - Delivers personalized calorie/macro plan
  - Before showing results: collects **name, email, and phone number** → enters GoHighLevel CRM
  - Results page includes a VSL (video sales letter) saying: "Now that you have a plan, if you want real help, book a strategy session with me" → calendar link
- Why collect phone + email:
  - Can't rely on DM replies alone
  - Enables SMS follow-up, email follow-up — **4 total touchpoints** to get someone on a call:

        - DM with free resource link
        - Thank-you page with calendar booking option
        - SMS follow-up
        - Email follow-up
    - Going from 1 touchpoint to 4 dramatically increases conversion rate
- How to build it:
    - Use **GoHighLevel's AI Studio** (similar to Lovable's vibe-coding)
    - Talk/type prompts to build the quiz/tool — no coding required
    - Brandon built it by whispering voice commands for changes
    - GoHighLevel also has a macro calculator tool and diet plan generator (templates included in Brandon's GoHighLevel bundle)
- GoHighLevel replaces ManyChat for DM automation
- **30-day free trial** available (link in description); includes all Brandon's templates, websites, AI tools, and pre-built agents

📅 Step 10: Automate Follow-Up with AI Agents 39:14

- GoHighLevel AI agents handle the entire follow-up sequence without human involvement:
    - Automated DM conversations to book sales calls
    - AI SMS messages to book calls
    - AI email outreach to schedule appointments
- You never personally text or email leads — AI does it all
- This is what separates top earners from beginners:
    - "I've never seen anyone make a million dollars on DMs alone"
    - Top community earners all use GoHighLevel (or another CRM) with systematic phone + email follow-up
    - Relying solely on DM replies is "pretty amateur"
- With automated agents + 4 touchpoints, even a small audience generates a meaningful number of sales calls
    - Especially critical when you have a small following — you can't afford to waste any lead

🎬 Step 11: Post at Scale Using AI Video Editing 41:05

- Brandon's posting volume in the last 30 days across 4 platforms: **882 pieces of content**

Platform	Volume
Instagram	300 Reels + 8 feed posts
TikTok	390 videos

Platform	Volume
YouTube	84 Shorts + 33 long-form = 117 total
Facebook	148 Reels

- **95% of editing is done by AI** — this is how that volume is possible
- Minimum recommended posting frequency: **3 Reels/day on each platform**; top earners post far more; if you don't post daily, Brandon says he won't take you seriously
- **AI editing stack:**
  - Use **Claude Code** or **ChatGPT desktop app (Codex)**
    - Claude Code model: Opus 5.5
    - Codex model: Astra (or Soul — cheaper, fewer credits, still decent)
    - Brandon has max subscriptions to both (~$500/month each) and uses whichever has credits left
  - Install three free GitHub repositories:
    - **Deep Filter Net** — audio filtering; Brandon runs every video through this before posting
    - **Hyperframes** — video editing framework
    - **Video Use** — teaches the AI how to work with video
  - Install **ElevenLabs** (paid but cheap tier is fine):
    - Get an API key → install in Claude Code / Codex
    - Significantly improves transcription accuracy and caption/graphic sync
    - Worth paying for — graphics/captions break without it
- **Workflow to recreate an outlier video:**
  - Download the MP4 of a video you like
  - Open Claude Code: "I want to recreate this video in my style"
  - Claude Code knows your style (from previous interactions) → writes a short script in your voice → edits and produces the reel
  - 100% of Brandon's long-form YouTube videos are produced this way
- **Skills system** (saved AI editing templates for recurring formats):
  - Example: "Three Stack" skill — creates a specific 3-clip stacked format
  - To trigger: open Codex → "Use my Three Stack skill to make a video quickly. Use that B-roll of me grabbing my girlfriend's butt in the pool in the middle."
  - AI finds the right B-roll from your stored files, assembles the video, adds captions, and offers to post it
  - Example demonstrated live in video: entire reel produced in seconds
  - Skills are reusable — build once, deploy forever
- All skills + editing guide included in the GoHighLevel bundle (free trial link in description)

📊 Step 12: Carousels, Scheduling & Putting It All Together 46:51

- Carousels currently perform very well on social media — include them in your content mix
- **IG Carousel skill workflow:**
  - Prompt: "Use my King Keto carousel skill on this YouTube/Instagram video"
  - AI analyzes the video, breaks it into steps, writes a summary for each slide
  - Tells you how many images it needs (e.g., 18 photos) → you upload them → it assembles the carousel with captions per slide
- **Posting workflow:**
  - Edit video in Codex or Claude Code
  - Connect GoHighLevel to your social accounts
  - Prompt: "Use GoHighLevel to post this to every platform"
  - Posts automatically — no manual uploading across platforms
- **Complete system recap (in order):**
  - Pick a service/coaching niche
  - Niche down to a specific audience + problem + method
  - Price at ~$997 (high-ticket from day one)
  - Use AI to validate niche and understand audience psychology
  - Find 10x outlier content (Sorter, VidIQ, Scrape Creators, Viral Content Vault)
  - Recreate outliers in your own voice using AI interview + scripting
  - Add CTA → trigger automated DM → open conversation → book call
  - Capture email + phone via interactive lead magnet (GoHighLevel quiz)
  - Use GoHighLevel AI agents to follow up via SMS + email automatically
  - Edit and post at scale (3+ Reels/day) using Claude Code / Codex + GitHub repos + ElevenLabs
  - Use skills for recurring formats; use carousel skill for additional content types
  - Next step: learn how to close the sales call (Brandon to publish a dedicated video on this)